

A picture speaks a thousand words

Draw a picture and hide a book of thoughts within, using steganography



IMAGING: Atul Deshmukh

Fishing freshwater bends and saltwater coasts rewards anyone feeling stressed. Resourceful anglers usually find masterful leapers fun and admit swordfish rank overwhelming anyday.

Still trying to figure out what this means? This is a crudely encrypted message for communicating secretly with someone. By taking the third letter in each word, the message reads: "Send Lawyers, guns and money."

To some degree or the other, we are all familiar with the art of stealthy communication and passing secret messages. We've done it in school, devising 'secret' code like the one shown above to communicate with an exclusive band of friends. We've read about it in spy thrillers—from fairly low-tech

methods like hiding information about traitors to the French revolution in a piece of knitting (*A Tale of Two Cities*), invisible ink, ultrawide radio transmissions that hide messages within noise-like signals and what have you. We've tried to secure our own communications by hiding information through encryption. And now there's another subset to the art of keeping it secret—steganography.

Stegano...what?

The word Steganography literally means 'covered writing'. The technique dates back to the ancient Greeks who sent information by scraping the wax off a tablet and writing a message on the underlying wood. The tablets were then covered with wax again, rendering them innocent when inspected by the sentries. In modern times, the technique works to camouflage information. You can hide data

Steganos Security Suite 4,
S-Tools 4
Find them on the Mindware CD

